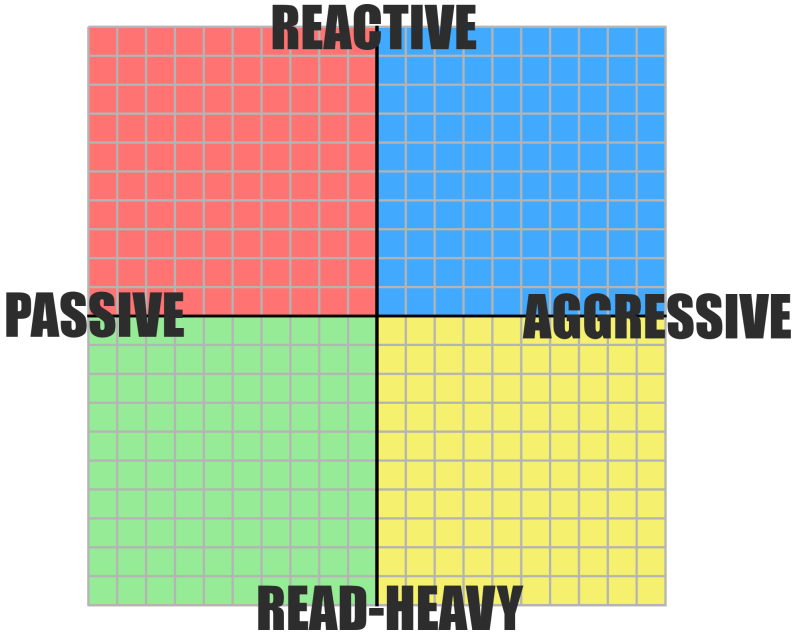
Elden Ring PvP Lexicon

The discussions around Elden Ring PvP have a lot of terms which originate from previous Soulsborne titles, from fighting games in general, from data mining Elden Ring, etc. Understandably, things can get confusing every now and then. This lexicon aims to explain these terms in-depth.

Aggressive/Passive, Reactive/Read-Heavy Red/Blue/Green/Yellow Quadrant



Players are often categorised based on two metrics:

- A *reactive* player waits for their opponent to make a move, then attempts to gain an advantage based on that. A *read-heavy* player will instead predict their opponent's move and set up their next attack based on that.
- A *passive* player will stay at distance in neutral and wait for their opponent to come to them. An *aggressive* player will close distance instead.

Furthermore, a lot of players have been using the above graph as a template, to the point where people are sometimes referred to as being e.g. a "yellow quadrant player" or "blue quadrant player", which sums up their playstyle based on their position on this graph.

Aimpunch

When a player is hit while attacking, even if they poise the attack, a flinch animation plays. The game mixes this flinch animation with the current attack animation, which can throw the player's weapon off course and can even make the attack miss completely.

See also:

- Why Do Elden Ring Hitboxes Randomly Miss (YouTube)

Backswing

A backswing is a secondary attack, like the second R1 (R1 2) in a chain of (light) attacks. In a lot of movesets, the first R1 will swing the weapon towards the enemy, and the second R1 will swing it back, somewhat in the opposite direction.

Backswings on many weapons are able to put opponents into frame disadvantage, because the hitstun from attacks typically lasts longer than the recovery from an attack into the backswing. However, this is not always the case. When we say that an attack “has backswing”, it refers to this property of putting an opponent into frame disadvantage.

Block Cancel

Blocking in Elden Ring has a variety of applications which fall under the umbrella term *block cancelling*:

- Running without ever pivoting (i.e. cancelling the pivot)
- Repeating running jumps (i.e. cancelling the walking state)
- Performing a running jump towards the opponent and instantly running back without pivoting
- Cancelling the recovery of an attack (see *recovery cancel*)
- Cancelling the crouching state, e.g. to perform a neutral R1

See also:

- Elden Ring Tech: Block Canceling

Chip Damage

Chip damage refers to small amounts of damage coming from consumables, projectiles, and sometimes melee weapons, typically below 10% of player HP.

Counter-Hit, Counter-Damage

Attacks in Elden Ring have counter-frames towards the middle/end of their animation. These frames usually occur during the active frames of an attack and shortly after. During these frames, the damage negation of pierce damage of a player is lowered and getting hit is called a *counter-hit*.

Spear Talisman will further increase pierce damage by 15% on a counter-hit, i.e. *counter-damage*. In total, you can expect 50% extra pierce damage on counter-hits. When you deal counter-damage, you can also see a white spark appear near the blood splatter on your opponent.

Note that counter-hits are exclusive to pierce damage; if your thrusting weapon has an affinity component like lightning, the lightning damage will not be increased on a counter-hit. This is why Elden Ring PvP players usually prefer pure physical thrusting weapons over weapons with affinities.

Whether counter-damage can be dealt is up to each individual attack. For example, the Great Epee heavy thrusting sword has a pierce damage R1 thrust, but a slashing R2 which does not deal pierce damage. There are also attacks which look like a thrusting move, but don't deal pierce damage: most notably, the Serpent Hunter crouch poke. Furthermore, there are attacks which do deal pierce damage, but don't look like thrusting moves: most notably, the Serpent Hunter JR2.

Critical Attack - Backstab, Riposte [1.08]

After parrying or breaking the guard of an enemy, your R1 attack will turn into a powerful riposte attack. This attack keeps you and your opponent in i-frames during the animation and inflicts massive damage. When performing R1 close to the back of your opponent, you start a backstab.

Weapon	Backstab MV	Riposte MV
Daggers A	308	440
Daggers B	280	400
Dagger	364	520
Miséricorde	392	560
Straight Swords A	220	330
Straight Swords B	200	300
Greatswords A	220	275
Greatswords B	200	250
Colossal Swords	50 + 160	50 + 200
Rapier	286	429
Rogier's Rapier	242	363
Thrusting Swords	220	330
Heavy Thrusting Swords	200	240
Curved Swords	200	300
Curved Greatswords	50 + 160	50 + 200
Morgott's Cursed Sword	55 + 176	55 + 220
Katanas	200	300
Twinblades	200	300
Axes	50 + 175	50 + 275
Highland Axe	55 + 192.5	55 + 302.5
Greataxes	50 + 160	50 + 200
Executioner's Greataxe	57.5 + 184	57.5 + 230
Hammers	50 + 175	50 + 275

Flails	50 + 175	50 + 275
Great Hammers	50 + 160	50 + 200
Colossal Weapons	50 + 160	50 + 200
Spears	200	280
Death Ritual Spear	220	308
Great Spears	200	240
Halberds	200	280
Reapers	200	240
Whips	N/A	N/A
Fists	50 + 220	50 + 330
Katar	55 + 242	55 + 330
Claws	55 + 242	55 + 330
Venomous Fang	50 + 220	50 + 300
Sacred Seals	100	N/A
Torches	200	300

MV = Motion Value

Daggers are the most powerful riposte tools, along with high AR weapons like colossal swords:

Weapon	Stats	2H AR	Riposte MV	Raw Damage
Heavy Greatsword (GUGS)	78 STR 12 DEX	871	50 + 200	2177.5
Fire Giant Crusher	80 STR 10 DEX	981	50 + 200	2452.5
Lightning Miséricorde	80 DEX	469	560	2626.4
Lightning Noble's Slender Sword	80 DEX	570	330	1881
Keen Guardian's Swordspear	17 STR 73 DEX	757	280	2119.6

Raw damage refers to the damage before defence/damage negation calculations

See also:

- ER - Motion Values and Attack Data

Damage Count

Damage count is a hidden mechanic in Elden Ring, previously seen in Dark Souls 3. Whenever you are hit, your damage count is increased. When you roll away, attack, or otherwise exit hitstun, the count is reset to zero. The greater the count, the sooner you can roll out of hitstun.

This mechanic prevents you from getting stunlocked when being attacked by multiple enemies. After the fourth hit, you are able to instantly roll out of any hitstun animation. However, the time until weapon art (e.g. Quickstep) is never shortened.

See also:

- [DS3] The Hidden Mechanic Behind Combos and Infinites | DamageCount (YouTube)

Damage Level [1.08]

Damage Level is a property of attacks which dictates how much a player is staggered when getting hit.

Dmg Level	Effect	Frames To Roll / WA		Examples
0	No stagger	0	0	Poison Mist
1	Short stagger	10	7	Straight Sword R1, Thunderbolt
2	Moderate stagger	25	24	Greatsword R1, Ice Spear Startup Spin
3	Long stagger	35	30	Colossal Sword R1, Storm Stomp
4	Knockdown	?	?	Ancient Lightning Spear, Establish Order
5	Push and long stagger	35	35	Kick, Beast's Roar Bullet
6	Faceplant	54	59	Lion's Claw, Gavel of Haima
7	Knockdown	93	93	Rejection, Placidusax's Ruin
8	Very short stagger	11	14	Bestial Sling, Dagger R1
9	Tossed into the air, "burger flip"	84	89	Giant Hunt, Black Flame Tornado
10	Knockdown	?	?	Onyx Lord's Repulsion
11	Knockdown	?	?	Wave of Gold

Frames at 30 FPS, 1 frame = 33ms

Note 1: There are multiple animations for the same damage level, so the recovery data is not universally applicable; the actual frames to roll may depend on the angle at which you are hit, the kind of attack, etc.

Note 2: Depending on your damage count (see above) you may be able to roll out of hitstun earlier.

The effect of each damage level is changed against a parried or sleeping opponent. For example, damage level 3 attacks will knock down opponents like damage level 7, and damage level 1 will stagger longer, allowing for true combos.

Dead Angling

In some previous Soulsborne games, it is possible to manually aim attacks in such a way that they bypass the shield of an opponent who is blocking in front of you, because they hit the opponent from the side or behind, where the shield is inactive.

The term is frequently (mis)used to refer to a variety of techniques related to manually aimed attacks. Free-Aiming is another way to refer to those other techniques.

Defence and Damage Negation, Competitive Defence [1.08]

For any type of the damage, the player has defences and negation values which reduce (or sometimes increase) the damage taken. Defences come from player stats, while damage negation comes from armour and buffs.

The calculations work as follows (code is written in Python 3):

```
def damage(atk, defence , abs):
    result = atk * (1 - abs / 100)
    if defence > 8 * atk:
        return result * 0.1
    if defence > atk:
        return result * (19.2/49 * (atk / defence - 0.125)**2 + 0.1)
    if defence > 0.4 * atk:
        return result * (-0.4/3 * (atk / defence - 2.5)**2 + 0.7)
    if defence > 0.125 * atk:
        return result * (-0.8/121 * (atk / defence - 8)**2 + 0.9)
    else:
        return result * 0.9
```

*atk = raw attack damage, def = defence, abs = absorption/damage negation, x**2 = x^2*

Effectively, this produces increasing returns, so the more damage your attack already does, the more your profit from additional damage. This effect is most visible below and round attacks which do roughly as much damage as the defence of the player. If the attack does more than 8 times the damage as a defence stat, the resulting damage becomes proportional to the raw damage and the curve becomes a line. As you can see in the calculations, damage negation simply becomes a multiplier for the resulting damage and has a much simpler relationship.

We consider a defence of 140 and a negation of 30 to be *competitive defence*, because it is a good average for RL 125 combat with good armour. That being said, lightning defence is usually lower than 140, because it only scales with rune level (127 defence at RL 125). Fire defence is usually greater, because it scales with vigor, and competitive players usually have plenty of vigor.

Empty Jump

When you jump towards your opponent without performing any attack, this is called an empty jump. Empty jumps are useful to bait out panic rolls once you have landed. They also close distance between yourself and the opponent, possibly up to their face, since your opponent will likely not want to trade with a jump attack.

Fast Weapon Art vs. Slow Weapon Art [1.08]

Certain weapon arts aka. skills are classified as “fast”. This includes (list may be incomplete):

- No Skill
- Lion’s Claw
- Double Slash
- Prelate’s Charge
- Unsheathe
- Square Off
- Lightning Ram
- Flame of the Redmanes
- Determination
- Royal Knight’s Resolve
- Quickstep
- Bloodhound’s Step
- Raptor of the Mists
- White Shadow’s Lure
- Unblockable Blade
- Sword Dance (since 1.07)
- Vow of the Indomitable (since 1.07)
- Eochaid’s Dancing Blade (since 1.07)
- Stamp (Upward Cut) / Stamp (Sweep) (since 1.07)
- Impaling Thrust (since 1.07)
- Piercing Fang (since 1.07)
- Charge Forth (since 1.07)
- Blood Tax, Repeating Thrust (since 1.07)
- Giant Hunt (since 1.07)
- Loretta’s Slash (since 1.07)
- Poison Moth Flight (since 1.07)
- Bloody Slash (since 1.07)
- Lifesteal Fist (since 1.07)
- Storm Blade (since 1.07)
- Flaming Strike (since 1.07)
- Lightning Slash (since 1.07)
- Blood Blade (since 1.07)
- Phantom Slash (since 1.07)
- War Cry (since 1.07)
- Ordovis’s Vortex (since 1.07)
- Wild Strikes (since 1.07)
- Spinning Strikes (since 1.07)

These weapon arts can be used earlier during another animation. For example, after a one-handed thrusting sword R1, you can use a fast weapon art on the first frame after the active frames of the attack ended, meaning that there is essentially zero recovery from R1 into Quickstep. Slow weapon arts require 4 frames of waiting before they can be used, i.e. they can be used on the fifth frame after the active frames have ended.

Weapon Class	Attack	Recovery to Dodge	Recovery to Fast WA
Thrusting Sword	1H R1 1	3	0
	2H R1 1	5	3
	Offhand 1	7	4
	1H CR1	12	7
	2H CR1	7	3
	1H BR1	10	6
	2H BR1	6	1
	Shield Poke	7	9
Straight Sword	1H R1 1	8	6
	1H CR1 (Poke)	9	9
	L1 1	5	5
	CL1	9	11
	JL1	8	8
	1H BR1	7	11
	BL1	10	10
Katana	1H R1 1	5	5
	1H CR1	8	7
	CL1	11	12
	JL1	15	14
	1H BR1	9	9
	BL1	8	6
Spear	1H CR1	8	4
	L1 1	7	7
	RL1	9	9
	CL1	6	6
	1H BR1	9	7
	BL1	8	9
	Shield Poke	9	10
Heavy Thrusting Sword	1H R1 1	10	7
	2H R1 1	8	3
	1H RR2	12	9
	2H RR2	16	13
	1H CR1	13	10
	2H CR1	13	8
	2H JR1	6	2
	2H JR2	12	13
	1H BR1	10	7
	2H BR1	10	7
	Shield Poke	13	10

Stagger Animation	Recovery to Dodge	Recovery to WA
Dmg Level 1	10	7
Dmg Level 2	25	24
Dmg Level 3	35	30
Dmg Level 5	35	35
Dmg Level 8	10	7

Dodge Animation	Recovery to Dodge	Recovery to Fast WA
Quickstep (Forwards)	10	7
Quickstep (Backwards)	8	6
Quickstep (Sideways)	7	6
BHStep (Forwards)	9	7
BHStep (Backwards)	7	7
BHStep (Sideways)	6	6

Great Spear	**1H CR1**	13	11
	2H CR1	13	11
	CL1	15	15
	JL1	19	19
	2H BR1	13	12
	BL1	11	10
	Shield Poke	12	11
Halberd	**1H RR1**	12	9
	2H RR1	13	9
	2H R1 1 (BKH)	10	6
	2H CR1	13	12
	1H BR1	10	7
	2H BR1	12	8
	BL1	9	6
Reaper	**1H CR1**	13	10
	2H CR1	14	14
	2H R1 1	14	10
	2H RR1	14	11
	1H BR1	12	9
	2H BR1	15	13
Greatsword	**2H R1 1 (Clay)**	10	8
	2H R2 1 (Clay)	11	11
	2H CR1	12	12
	2H JR1	15	12
	2H BR1	10	10
	BL1	14	14

Note: All data is given in frames at 30 FPS, 1 frame = 33 ms

Fast weapon arts also appear to be handled differently by the input queue in Elden Ring. For example, during a katana JR2, it is possible to queue up a Spinning Slash, but not Double Slash.

See also:

- Elden Ring Frame Data Explorer

Foresight

Foresight in fighting games is the ability to understand whether a certain exchange is winning or losing. Foresight is acquired through experience.

It is important to understand whether you should attempt to roll through an opponent's attack, block, or to attempt a trade on reaction (reaction trade). For example, if the opponent

attacks you with a slow attack and you have a katana sheathed, it is best to unsheathe into them on reaction and either interrupt them or to trade, at least if you have an HP advantage.

Frame Trap

A frame trap is an attack or string of attacks that can't be fully avoided by rolling through it, i.e. dodging it using nothing but i-frames. This usually involves one part of the attack forcing a dodge, with subsequent parts roll-catching during recovery frames between rolls. Examples include:

- Spinning Slash
- Double Slash Follow-Up
- Light attack spam on numerous weapons, such as Shamshir, Dagger, Thrusting Sword, …

Such attacks can still be avoided by rolling out of their range, but not by rolling through them and staying in the same spot.

Note: In other fighting games, frame trap is often synonymous with frame disadvantage

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Free-Aiming

Some attacks in Elden Ring -especially horizontal slashes- can behave differently when manually aiming them to the side, downwards, or upwards. Examples include:

- Aiming upwards to prevent an opponent from jumping over them
- Aiming downwards to extend their range slightly (e.g. Unsheathe R2, PS GSpears CL1, ...)
- Aiming sideways to make them hit on an earlier frame
- Aiming sideways to make them connect on a later frame, possibly allowing for true combos
- Aiming backwards to prevent your opponent from whiff-punishing you

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Fundamentals

Fundamentals are game skills which are universal to every weapon. Fundamentals are necessary to master PvP.

Elden Ring Fundamentals:

- Foresight
- Spacing/zoning
- Reaction-rolling/dodging
- Game knowledge
- Stamina management
- Poise counting

Fundamentals Weapon

Some weapons, especially PS SS (Powerstanced/Paired Straight Swords) are often referred to as a fundamentals weapon. This means that there is no hidden gimmick to how to play the weapon, and you don't rely on constantly using ashes of war. You simply use melee attacks and rely on the above mentioned fundamentals to use the weapon.

GUGS, WUGS

GUGS stands for "Greatsword Ultra Greatsword" and refers to the Colossal Sword named Greatsword in Elden Ring. This abbreviation originated in Dark Souls 3. This name is useful to disambiguate between the Greatsword weapon and the Greatsword weapon class.

Elden Ring players started using this pattern for other weapons, like WUGS for Watchdog's Greatsword.

Hard-Swap vs. Soft-Swap

You can swap between weapons, either by switching between multiple weapons that you are carrying (soft-swapping), or by replacing your current weapon in your inventory (hard-swapping) by menuing. Soft-swapping is much easier, as it requires a single button press. Hard-swapping can sometimes be faster, as no animation is played while swapping and you can use the weapon instantly after leaving the menu.

Hard-swapping is perceived as unfair by some players, but the PvP community at large permits it, and it is not banned in any ladder or tournament ruleset.

Holy Damage Bug

For unknown reasons, holy damage is not increased by otherwise damage increasing effects. For example, Coded Sword jump attacks are not affected by Claw Talisman in PvP, but they are buffed in PvE. Any talisman or buff which directly increases damage simply has no effect on holy damage in PvP.

See also:

- Elden Ring PvP - Holy Damage Bug (YouTube)

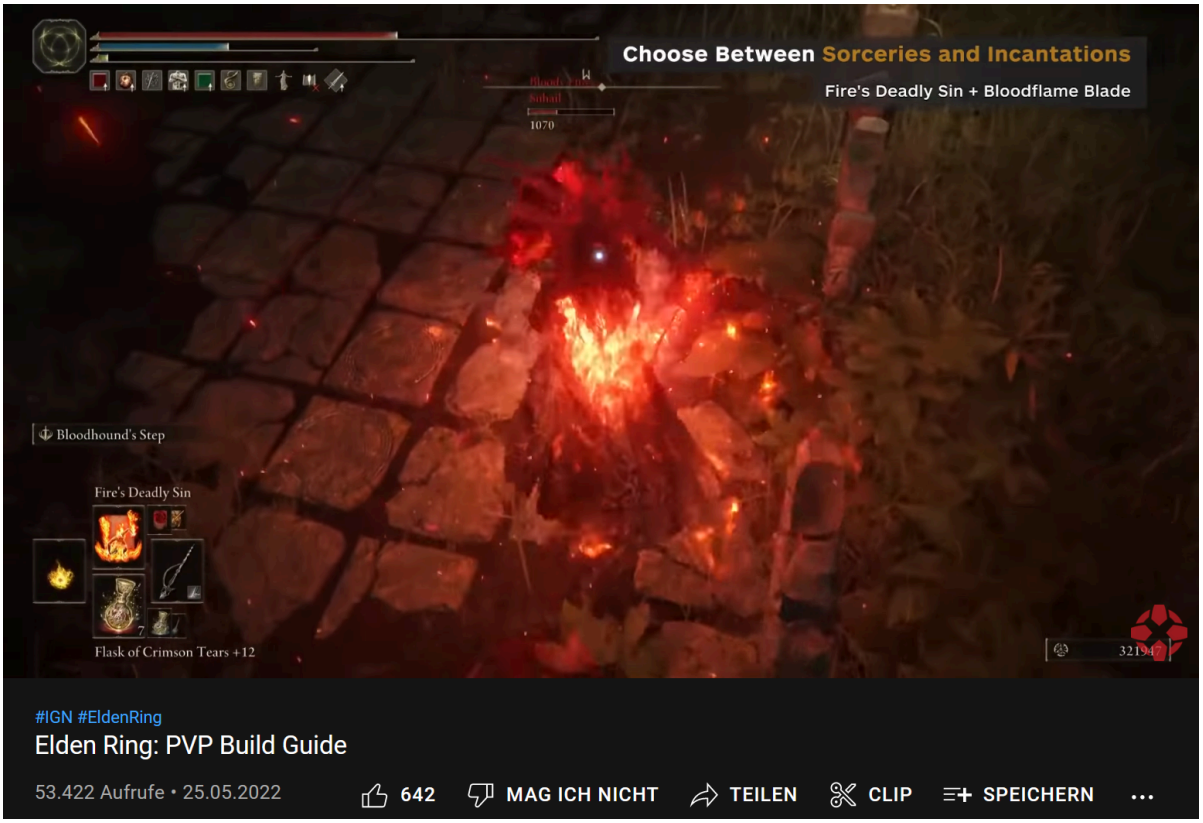
Hyper Armor

Hyper armour is a state which the player enters when using specific attacks. Heavy weapons like Greataxes typically give you hyper armour on every attack. Hyper armour essentially gives the player increased *poise* during the attack, and also permanently recovers some amount of *poise health*.

See also:

- ER Poise Calculator

IGN Glitch, IGN Build



On May 25 2022, IGN posted a video titled Elden Ring: PVP Build Guide. This video was widely circulated in the PvP community and mocked for multiple reasons:

- Showing no awareness that the PvP meta is at RL 125 or RL 150
- Being ill-informed about the viability of certain weapons, such as Bloodhound's Fang
- Recommending poor build practice such as using soreseals over RL 200
- Promoting toxic strategies such as shield poking with Fingerprint Stone Shield
- **Promoting the use of exploits**

The exploit promoted by the PvP guide is the Bloodflame Blade + Fire's Deadly Sin Glitch, where Fire's Deadly Sin massively gains blood loss buildup because the main hand buff is falsely applied to it. As a result, this exploit was nicknamed "IGN glitch" or "IGN build".

Invulnerability Frames aka. i-Frames [1.08]

When the player rolls or uses certain weapon skills, they become invulnerable for some amount of frames. During this period, the player cannot receive any damage from attacks, but they can still be afflicted with status buildup through *phantom hits*.

Animation		Startup	i-Frames	Recovery to Roll / Ash of War	
Light Roll		0	13	8	6
Medium Roll		0	13	8	7
Heavy Roll		0	12	16	11
Bloody Helice		0	20	14	9
Vow of the Indomitable		4	30	1	10
Bloodhound's Finesse		58	20	25	N/A
Raptor of the Mists		0	18	N/A	N/A
Bloodhound's Step	**Forwards**	0	16	9	7
	Forwards, Repeated	0	14	11	11
	Backwards	0	16	7	7
	Backwards, Repeated	0	14	9	11
	Sideways	0	16	6	6
	Sideways, Repeated	0	14	8	13
Medium/Heavy Load Quickstep	**Forwards**	0	15	10	7
	Forwards, Repeated	0	13	12	9
	Backwards	0	15	8	6
	Backwards, Repeated	0	13	10	8
	Sideways	0	15	7	6
	Sideways, Repeated	0	13	9	8
Light Load Quickstep	**Forwards**	0	15	10	7
	Forwards, Repeated	0	14	10	7
	Backwards	0	15	8	6
	Backwards, Repeated	0	14	8	6
	Sideways	0	15	7	6
	Sideways, Repeated	0	14	7	6

Note: All data is given in frames at 30 FPS, 1 frame = 33 ms

See also:

- ER - Parry + iFrame Data - for a much more detailed list

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i-Frame Duplication, Roll-Spam Immortality

In Elden Ring, you can only deal damage with an attack if the opponent is outside of i-frames on your screen and on their screen. If the opponent is in i-frames on your screen, your attack doesn't attempt to damage them. If the opponent was damaged on your screen but is already in i-frames on theirs, they will also not receive damage, but a *phantom hit*.

For every frame of latency, effectively, one frame of recovery is removed. If your opponent has approximately 8 frames = 270 ms of latency and is spamming light/medium rolls, then they will always be in i-Frames on your screen or on their own, making them immortal to any

damage other than status effects. This allows them to do things that are normally impossible, like rolling into their opponent's Flaming Strike and back out of it without taking damage.

See also:

- How Lag Makes You Invincible (YouTube, demonstration in DS3, netcode works the same in ER)

Irregular Poise Event (IPE) aka. Random Poise Event (RPE)

In some rare cases, players don't get staggered by attacks that they clearly shouldn't be able to poise. Even powerstanced great spear jumping attacks sometimes don't stagger opponents, seemingly randomly. An IPE can be recognized by the fact that no flinching animation will be played whatsoever when the opponent is hit by an attack. Poising an attack normally will result in a slight flinching animation, possibly leading to aimpunch, contrary to an IPE.

The exact reason for why this happens is unknown, but IPEs most commonly occur when:

- A melee headshot is involved, i.e. the opponent gets hit in the head
- The opponent is turning just as they get hit
- The opponent is beginning to crouch just as they get hit

Kill Confirmation

Kill confirmation is the act of finishing an opponent off when they are at low health. When discussing tactics for kill confirmation, this typically involves ways of doing small amounts of damage, but as reliably as possible.

Knowledge Check

A knowledge check is an attack or playstyle which tests the opponent's game knowledge. For example, using status effects checks if the opponent knows about talismans that increase their status resistances, and whether they know that they can remove these status effects with boluses.

Knowledge check is sometimes used in a condescending manner, referring to strategies which become useless if the opponent knows about them.

Motion Value (MV)

Motion values are multipliers for properties of attacks. They include:

- Physical/Affinity attack motion values
- Status motion values
- Poise damage motion values
- Stamina damage motion values

For example, the actual poise damage of a weapon is calculated by multiplying the poise damage motion value and the base poise damage of the weapon. Except for poise damage MVs, all MVs of a one-handed R1 are typically 100, so you can see them as a percentage of a light attack.

See also:

- ER - Motion Values and Attack Data

Neutral, Neutral Game

In fighting games, there are three states that players can find themselves in:

- **Advantage** - Player is pressuring their opponent
- **Disadvantage** - Player is being pressured by their opponent
- **Neutral** - Neither player has the advantage

While players are in neutral, they are typically closer to the middle of the stage and attempting to put the opponent into disadvantage, e.g. through *zoning*.

Neutral Jump

A neutral jump is a technique where the player jumps while standing still. If their opponent attacks them during this, the jump can avoid this attack and counter it with a jump attack. Neutral jumps work similarly to parrying because they are predictions of your opponent attacking you. However, they are often safer and require much less precision than a parry.

From testing during PvP, it appears like neutral jumps have very good tracking when used while walking, but have no tracking whatsoever when used during a recovery, e.g. after performing an attack.

Offstoc, Offkiba, etc.

Players refer to offhand weapons with these abbreviations:

- **Offstoc** - offhand thrusting sword, not necessarily Estoc
- **Offkiba** - offhand Nagakiba
- **Offpike** - offhand Pike

Passive Poise vs. Active Poise

When a player is hit while they are not attacking, and manages to not get staggered, i.e. “poises” the attack, this effect is called *passive poise*. Also refer to the lexicon entry for poise for more information.

While the player is attacking, they may also receive hyper-armour which lets them poise more attacks, and we refer to the calculations when they get hit as *active poise*.

Parry Frames [1.08]

Not every tool for parrying is made equal in Elden Ring. Some parries have significantly better frame data, meaning that the active parry frames appear earlier in the animation, and there are more of them, so there is a longer window during which an attack may be parried.

Parry Tool	Startup	Parry Frames	Recovery to Roll / Ash of War	
Golden Parry	4	6	15	16
Carian Retaliation	4	6	15	16
Buckler	4	5	16	18
Small Shield	5	5	15	16
Storm Wall	5	5	15	16
Dagger	6	4	15	16
Thop's Barrier	6	4	15	16
Medium Shield, Thrusting Sword, First, Claw (Offhand)	6	2	17	18
Fist/Claw (Mainhand)	6	2	15	16
Curved Sword	6	2	17	18

Note 1: All data is given in frames at 30 FPS, 1 frame = 33 ms
Note 2: Ashes of War like Golden Parry have the same frame data on small/medium shields

Windy Crystal Tear and Crucible Feather Talisman add +3 iframes and therefore -3 recovery to Light, Medium, and Heavy Roll. No other iframes are affected by these, and they do not stack.

See also:

- ER - Parry + iFrame Data - for a much more detailed list

Perfect Block

When a player starts blocking at the same frame as they are hit, they will block without entering block stun, but still lose stamina. It is commonly seen that a player takes full damage instead of blocking, but bypasses hit stun with this technique. This indicates that the perfect block is likely a bug.

Phantom Headshot

When a physical projectile like a fan dagger or arrow hits your opponent in the head, a headshot animation plays which staggers them for a long time. This is even possible on a

phantom hit, so you only need to headshot them on your screen. The phantom hit will still deal no damage, but it will stagger them, interrupting the roll on your opponent's screen.

Phantom Hit

A phantom hit occurs when you hit an opponent on your screen, but on their screen, they roll or otherwise enter invulnerability-frames before they get hit. Animations like a blood splatter and a sound effect will still be played, but the opponent receives no damage. Status effects are built up as if you hit them normally, possibly resulting in a phantom proc.

Phantom Miss aka. Phantom Anti-Hit

This is the exact opposite effect of a phantom hit. Visually, you get hit on your screen by a projectile or melee attack, but it deals no damage to you because the attack did not connect on your opponent's screen. This effect is most noticeable when stopping to strafe projectiles, or when seemingly getting roll-caught by projectiles, but taking no damage. It occurs because on your opponent's screen, you were still strafing or in roll i-frames.

Phantom Proc - Phantom Blood Loss, Phantom Sleep, etc.

If status buildup reaches 100% during a phantom hit, the status effect is still applied.

Status Effect	Proc	Phantom Proc
Blood Loss	Damage and stun	Stun only
Frost	Damage, stun, lingering debuff	Stun and lingering debuff
Poison	Player is poisoned	Player is poisoned
Scarlet Rot	Player is afflicted with rot	Player is afflicted with rot
Sleep	Player is put to sleep, FP drain	Player is put to sleep, FP drain
Madness	Damage, FP drain, long stagger	FP drain and long stagger
Death	Player dies	Player dies

Players unfamiliar with phantom procs may assume that blood loss randomly doesn't do any damage. However, what actually happened is that their opponent rolled just before they got hit, resulting in a phantom hit and subsequent phantom proc.

Poise

Poise in Elden Ring is a stat which dictates how many attacks it will take until you are staggered. The player has an invisible *poise health* bar which depletes whenever they are hit. This includes phantom hits, so it is not necessary to take damage in order to take *poise damage*.

All attacks in Elden Ring deal some amount of *poise damage*, and the player is staggered if their *poise health* reaches zero, or if they are attacked in any way while having zero poise. Here is a list of ways that your *poise health* is changed:

- Getting hit by an attack decreases poise health, depending on the kind of attack
- Entering hyper armour increases poise health, but may not reset it completely
- Not getting hit for 30 seconds resets poise health to whatever your poise is

Even though the game doesn't display it as such to the player, poise and poise health are fractional. For example, full bullgoat armour gives the player ~99.9 poise, not exactly 100, but the game rounds this up when displaying the poise in menus. Poise damage is also fractional.

See also:

- Elden Ring Dissected #6 - Poise Explained (YouTube)

Poise Breakpoint [1.07]

A poise breakpoint is a poise value which allows you to poise one more attack. As a counter-example, 52 poise is not a breakpoint because having 52 poise instead of 51 will not allow you to poise any more attacks.

WIP

Poise Dmg	BrPoint	Breakpoint Meaning (1.08 WIP) (missing some info, such as Hammer and Flail)
0	1	Avoid zero poise damage attacks, e.g. Briar armour rolls
5	6	One Fan Dagger (5 daggers, 5 poise damage each)
10	11	Bone Dart, Throwing Dagger, Crystal Dart, etc.
20	21	Most arrows (20 poise damage, Stormwing Bone Arrow does 50 poise damage)
24.3	25	Dagger, Claw, Torch PS L1 half-hit (2-hit attacks)
27	28	Swift Glintstone Shard
30	31	Glintstone Pebble (Ash of War)
32.4	33	Thrusting Sword and Whip PS L1 half-hit
37.5	38	Double Slash 1 (1st hit), Double Slash 2 (1st, 2nd hit)
40.5	41	Carian Slicer, Glintstone Pebble (Spell)
		Straight Sword, Curved Sword, Katana, Axe, Twinblade, Spear, Fist PS L1 half–hit
		Dagger, Claw, Torch 1H R1
40.5	41	Dagger and Torch 1H R1
44		Thrusting Sword 1H R1
44.55	45	Heavy Thrusting Sword PS L1 half-hit
45	46	Light Weapon Spinning Slash 2 (1st hit)
48.599	49	Dagger and Claw PS L1 (2-hit attacks)
50	51	Stormwing Bone Arrow
		Double Slash 1 (second hit), Double Slash 2 (3rd hit)
		Barbaric Roar R2 (some hits)

		Thunderbolt
		Storm Assault Wind, Stormcaller Wind Tick
		Light Weapon Gravitas Stab
52.65	**53**	Dagger, Claw, Torch 2H R1
52.65	**53**	Dagger and Torch 2H R1
54	**55**	Various Dragon Breath Ticks
		Thrusting Sword and Whip 1H R1
54	**55**	Whip and Claw 1H R1
57.5	**58**	Straight Sword, Curved Sword, Katana, Twinblade, Axe, Spear 1H R1
60	**61**	Kick
		Colossal Sword Golden Land and Waves of Darkness Stab
		Beast's Roar, Thundercloud Form Tick, Prelate's Charge Tick, War Cry AoE, …
60.75		Dagger, Claw, Torch 1H JR1
64.799	**65**	Thrusting Sword and Whip PS L1
67.5	**68**	Unendurable Frenzy Bullet
		Honed Bolt
		Fist and Small Shield 1H R1
		Straight Sword, Curved Sword, Katana, Axe, Twinblade, Spear, Fist 1H R1
68.75	**69**	Small/Medium Shield Bash
70.2	**71**	Thrusting Sword and Whip 2H R1
72.899	**73**	Dagger PS L1 (3-hit attacks)
74.25	**75**	Heavy Thrusting Sword 1H R1
74.925		Halberd and Reaper PS L1 half-hit
75	**76**	Storm Blade Bullet
		Greatshield Bash
78.975	**79**	Dagger, Claw, Torch 2H JR1
80	**81**	Waves of Darkness Shockwave
80.999		Straight Sword, Curved Sword, Katana, Axe, Twinblade, Spear, Fist PS L1
81	**82**	Dagger, Claw, Torch 1H R2
82.418	**83**	Greatsword and Great Spear PS L1 half-hit
87.75	**88**	Straight Sword, Curved Sword, Katana, Axe, Twinblade, Spear, Fist 2H R1
89.099	**90**	Heavy Thrusting Sword PS L1
90	**91**	*2x Dagger, Claw, Torch 1H R1*
94.5	**95**	Catch Flame
96.525	**97**	Heavy Thrusting Sword 2H R1
100	**101**	Flaming Strike, Storm Stomp, Ice Spear Startup
		Double Slash 3
		Lightning Slash Lightning
		Bloodboon Ritual (Mogh Spear)
		Golden Retaliation Bullet (Erdtree Greatshield)
		Cursed Blood Slicer (Bloodlame Bullet)

		Blade of Gold/Death Bullet
		Glintblade Phalanx (Ash of War) Blade
		Gravity Stone Fan
101.25	**102**	Straight Sword, Curved Sword, Katana, Axe, Twinblade, Spear 1H JR1
105.3	**106**	Dagger, Claw, Torch 2H R2
		Thrusting Sword 2H JR1
108	**109**	Thrusting Sword and Whip 1H R2
		2x Thrusting Sword and Whip 1H R1
111.375	**112**	Heavy Thrusting Sword 1H JR1
113.399	**114**	Claw PS JL1
114.873	**115**	Claw 2H RR2
118.8	**119**	Thrusting Sword and Whip 2H RR2, 2H BR1
121.499	**122**	Dagger and Curved Sword PS JL1
131.625	**132**	Fist 2H JR1
124.875	**125**	Halberd and Reaper 1H R1
130	**131**	Sacred Blade Bullet, Nebula Bullet (Wing of Astel, Bastard's Stars)

Poise Dmg	**BrPoint**	**Breakpoint Meaning (1.07) (missing some info, such as Hammer and Flail)**
0	**1**	Avoid zero poise damage attacks, e.g. Briar armour rolls
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		Dagger, Claw, Torch 1H R1
44.55	**45**	Heavy Thrusting Sword PS L1 half-hit
45	**46**	Light Weapon Spinning Slash 2 (1st hit)
48.599	**49**	Dagger and Claw PS L1 (2-hit attacks)
50	**51**	Stormwing Bone Arrow
		Double Slash 1 (second hit), Double Slash 2 (3rd hit)
		Barbaric Roar R2 (some hits)
		Thunderbolt
		Storm Assault Wind, Stormcaller Wind Tick
		Light Weapon Gravitas Stab
52.65	**53**	Dagger, Claw, Torch 2H R1

54	**55**	Various Dragon Breath Ticks
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		Beast's Roar, Thundercloud Form Tick, Prelate's Charge Tick, War Cry AoE, …
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87.75	**88**	Straight Sword, Curved Sword, Katana, Axe, Twinblade, Spear, Fist 2H R1
89.099	**90**	Heavy Thrusting Sword PS L1
90	**91**	*2x Dagger, Claw, Torch 1H R1*
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		2x Thrusting Sword and Whip 1H R1

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124.875	**125**	Halberd and Reaper 1H R1
130	**131**	Sacred Blade Bullet, Nebula Bullet (Wing of Astel, Bastard's Stars)

Also note that Elden Ring poise is translated into a toughness stat which has a lower maximum than poise. Poise damage subtracts from toughness, introducing floating point imprecision. Furthermore, armour poise is fractional, e.g. Bullgoat Armor gives ~99.6 poise and is rounded up to 100 when displayed in your menu. **As a result, 60 armour poise can sometimes be enough to protect against 60 poise damage, but this cannot be relied upon. The above list is always poise damage +1.**

Poise Counting

Poise counting is a technique of keeping track of your and your opponent's current poise health. When you get (phantom) hit, your poise health is depleted, and so is your opponent's. When it reaches zero, the poise health is reset.

Poise counting is necessary to know whether you will interrupt your opponent's next attack. If so, you can afford to play more aggressively and to pressure them. You should typically avoid performing attacks that will not break the poise of your opponent, since they can very easily *poise trade* with your attack otherwise.

Powerstance (PS)

A powerstance refers to using two weapons of the same type, one in the mainhand and one in the offhand. In this case, the L1 attack will not just swing the offhand weapon, but will use both weapons in a paired attack.

This term originates from Dark Souls 2, but is widely used in Elden Ring despite not being mentioned anywhere within the game. "Paired weapons" instead refers to weapons that give you a PS moveset when two-handed, such as Ornamental Straight Sword.

Priority

In an exchange of attacks, one player usually has priority over the other, especially if they are using different weapons. Priority is a form of advantage where if both opponents were to attack at the same time, the player with priority would win the exchange for some reason.

For example, if a player in Elden Ring gets hit by an attack, they usually don't have priority, because a follow-up attack of their opponent would hit them before they recover from the stagger animation and can perform their own attack.

A player can have priority because their attack has more damage or poise damage, or because it is significantly faster. If you don't have priority yourself, you typically have to gain distance from your opponent and reset to *neutral*, or you can parry or *neutral jump* if you predict that your opponent makes use of their priority.

Proc [1.08]

Proc comes from "programmed random occurrence". It was commonly used in World of Warcraft to describe when a random event happens during an attack, like poison damage.

In Elden Ring, the term is used to describe when status buildup reaches 100% and e.g. the blood loss effect is applied. It is a misuse of the term because it is not a random event.

	Additional Effect	Duration	FP Drain	Damage (Per Tick)	Dmg at 2000 HP	Dmg at 2700 HP
Bleed1	Short stun			⌊MaxHP * 0.15⌋ + 100	400	505
Bleed2	Short stun			⌊MaxHP * 0.15⌋ + 200	500	605
Frost	-20% damage negation & stamina recovery debuff	30 s		⌊MaxHP * 0.1⌋ + 30	230	300
Madness	Long stun	2 s	⌊MaxFP * 0.1⌋ + 30	⌊MaxHP * 0.15⌋ + 100	400	505
Sleep	Long stun	1 s	⌊MaxFP * 0.1⌋ + 30			
Poison1	Damage over time (1 Hz)	90 s		⌊MaxHP * 0.0007⌋ + 7	720	720
Poison2	Damage over time (1 Hz)	30 s		⌊MaxHP * 0.0014⌋ + 14	480	510
Poison3	Damage over time (1 Hz)	30 s		⌊MaxHP * 0.0012⌋ + 12	420	450
Poison4	Damage over time (1 Hz)	30 s		⌊MaxHP * 0.0042⌋ + 18	780	870
Poison5	Damage over time (1 Hz)	30 s		⌊MaxHP * 0.0021⌋ + 21	750	780
Scarlet Rot1	Damage over time (1 Hz)	90 s		⌊MaxHP * 0.0018⌋ + 15	1620	1710
Scarlet Rot2	Damage over time (1 Hz)	90 s		⌊MaxHP * 0.0018⌋ + 13	1440	1530

Note 1: the ⌊symbols⌋ mean rounding down
Note 2: There are further PvE variations of poison and rot
Note 3: Poison ticks can be i-framed, meaning that the total damage may be lower than e.g. 720

See also:

- ER - Miscallaneous Data - for further information on status effects

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Read, Hard Read

A read in fighting games is a prediction of your opponent's actions with a pre-emptive punishment for them. For example, you can predict that your opponent will attack when they get closer to you, and you attack them to interrupt them before they can do so.

A hard read is a read where you predict your opponent with great confidence and make a substantial commitment to the punishment. For example, a successful parry is always a hard read, and so is a neutral jump. In this case, you are predicting that your opponent will attack within a small time window, and then punishing them for it. Parries and neutral jumps can be punished and thus require commitment.

Recovery Canel

Moves in Elden Ring have a certain amount of recovery frames until the player can walk and perform an arbitrary move again. However, the amount of recovery frames into actions other than walking is typically lower.

For example, the recovery after a UGS crouch poke to walking is fairly long, but the player can crouch to end this recovery sooner.

See also:

- Elden Ring Frame Data Explorer

R1, R2, JR1, RR1, etc. Input Notation

Elden Ring players typically refer to attacks/inputs by these acronyms.

Acronym	Meaning
R1	Mainhand light attack
R2	Mainhand heavy attack
L1	Offhand/paired attack, blocking, etc.
RR1	Mainhand light running attack
RR2	Mainhand heavy running attack
RL1	Paired running attack
CR1	Mainhand crouch/rolling attack
CL1	Paired crouch/rolling attack
JR1	Mainhand light jumping attack
JR2	Mainhand heavy jumping attack
BR1	Mainhand backstep attack
BL1	Paired backstep attack
L2	Use of weapon skill
L3	Crouching

WDR1	= **RR1**, “while dashing R1”, DS3 lingo
WRR1	= **CR1**, “while rolling R1”, DS3 lingo

Note that there is no difference between a rolling and a crouch attack in Elden Ring, they are always the exact same attack. This is why **RR1** is unambiguous, as **CR1** can be used to refer to a rolling attack.

Reverse Backstep (Ravioli) [1.08]

This is a technique where you queue up a backstep during the recovery of an attack, and then start walking backwards so that the backstep doesn’t go backwards as usual, but forwards. You can then perform a backstep attack. This sequence is faster than recovering from an attack into running and performing a running attack.

Animation	Startup*	To Attack	To AoW	To Roll
Medium Backstep	2	9 - 11	12 - 14	16 - 18

Frame data is at 30 FPS and recovery windows do not include the startup

Cancel windows depend on equipment load

**during startup, your character doesn’t move yet and turning is enabled, which allows you to turn around before the hop*

The ravioli allows you to pressure opponents much more than with repeated running attacks, as both the reverse backstep and the backstep attack will close distance.

Reverse Quickstep

This technique is similar to the reverse quickstep, but can also be performed while walking. To perform it, you need to lock onto a target. Then, aim backwards, quickstep, and unlock all at the same time. This will result in your character performing a backwards quickstep, but towards your target. These inputs don’t have to be performed frame-perfectly at the same time, you have some leeway.

This technique is used for approaching the opponent with a backstep attack, or for backstabbing them. The reverse quickstep is a much less risky way of backstabbing opponents than using a reverse backstep, because it also has i-frames.

See also:

- The Reverse Quickstep | Elden Ring (YouTube)

Roll-Catching Combo

A roll-catching combo is a series of attacks that an opponent can roll out of, but that will roll-catch them if they panic roll, i.e. spam the roll button as soon as they are hit.

Examples:

- Great spear R1 into R2
- Great spear RR1 into R1
- Halberd RR1 into Impaling Thrust
- Halberd RR1 into Flaming Strike
- Unsheathe R1/R2 into Unsheathe R1

The key benefit of roll-catching combos is that they don't require any precision or careful timing to catch rolls. They work if you simply queue up attacks.

Rune Level (RL)

This is the level of a character. The meta, i.e. the level where competitive matches take place is 125 in Elden Ring. Another popular level is 150. For invasions, players often make characters at RL 137, allowing them to invade both 125 and 150.

Rising Jump Attack vs. Falling Jump Attack vs. Landing Jump Attack

When you perform a jump attack very early into the jump, i.e. while your character is gaining height, this is called a *rising jump attack*. When you are doing it late into the jump, i.e. while your character is losing height, this is called a *falling jump attack*. If your character touches the ground while performing the jump attack, it is a *landing jump attack*.

Falling and landing jump attacks have much better tracking than rising jump attacks, to the point where you can perform the attack and turn into the direction where you have jumped from.

Shield Poke [1.08]

When you block with a shield and simultaneously perform a light attack, you attack while blocking. You can get guard-broken during this attack.

Weapon	Pvp Poise Dmg	Attack MV	Damage Level	Startup Frames	Active Frames	Recovery To Roll	Recovery To Attack
Thrusting Sword	54	100	1	11	3	7	9
Heavy Thrusting Sword	74.25	100	1	13	3	13	10
Spear	67.5	85	1	12	4	9	9
Great Spear	137.3625	85	1	16	3	12	11

Frame Data at 30 FPS, 1 frame = 33ms

Note 1: Damage level 1 results in 10 frames hitstun until dodge, and 7 frames hitstun until attack; This means that the poked player always has a frame advantage

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Soft Cap vs. Hard Cap [1.08]

A soft cap is a level after which the gains from additional stat investment significantly increase or decrease. In most cases, the gains will decrease, but some soft caps, like 15 Mind, increase returns. A hard cap is the maximum of 99 which can be invested into a stat. See below the gains in HP from Vigor and Mind, with soft caps highlighted:

Vigor	HP	Delta
10	414	18
11	434	20
12	455	21
13	476	21
14	499	23
15	522	23
16	547	25
17	572	25
18	598	26
19	624	26
20	652	28
21	680	28
22	709	29
23	738	29
24	769	31
25	800	31
26	833	33
27	870	37
28	910	40
29	951	41
30	994	43
31	1037	43
32	1081	44
33	1125	44
34	1170	45
35	1216	46
36	1262	46
37	1308	46
38	1355	47

Vigor	HP	Delta
61	1906	6
62	1912	6
63	1918	6
64	1924	6
65	1930	6
66	1936	6
67	1942	6
68	1948	6
69	1954	6
70	1959	5
71	1965	6
72	1971	6
73	1977	6
74	1982	5
75	1988	6
76	1993	5
77	1999	6
78	2004	5
79	2010	6
80	2015	5
81	2020	5
82	2026	6
83	2031	5
84	2036	5
85	2041	5
86	2046	5
87	2051	5
88	2056	5
89	2060	4

Mind	FP	Delta
10	78	3
11	82	4
12	85	3
13	88	3
14	91	3
15	95	4
16	100	5
17	105	5
18	110	5
19	116	6
20	121	5
21	126	5
22	131	5
23	137	6
24	142	5
25	147	5
26	152	5
27	158	6
28	163	5
29	168	5
30	173	5
31	179	6
32	184	5
33	189	5
34	194	5
35	200	6
36	207	7
37	214	7
38	221	7

Mind	FP	Delta
61	352	2
62	355	3
63	357	2
64	360	3
65	362	2
66	365	3
67	367	2
68	370	3
69	373	3
70	375	2
71	378	3
72	380	2
73	383	3
74	385	2
75	388	3
76	391	3
77	393	2
78	396	3
79	398	2
80	401	3
81	403	2
82	406	3
83	408	2
84	411	3
85	414	3
86	416	2
87	419	3
88	421	2
89	424	3

39	1402	47
40	1450	48
41	1476	26
42	1503	27
43	1529	26
44	1555	26
45	1581	26
46	1606	25
47	1631	25
48	1656	25
49	1680	24
50	1704	24
51	1727	23
52	1750	23
53	1772	22
54	1793	21
55	1814	21
56	1834	20
57	1853	19
58	1871	18
59	1887	16
60	1900	13

90	2065	5
91	2070	5
92	2074	4
93	2078	4
94	2082	4
95	2086	4
96	2090	4
97	2094	4
98	2097	3
99	2100	3

39	228	7
40	235	7
41	242	7
42	248	7
43	255	7
44	262	7
45	268	6
46	275	7
47	281	6
48	287	6
49	293	6
50	300	7
51	305	5
52	311	6
53	317	6
54	322	5
55	328	6
56	333	5
57	338	5
58	342	4
59	346	4
60	350	4

90	426	2
91	429	3
92	432	3
93	434	2
94	437	3
95	439	2
96	442	3
97	444	2
98	447	3
99	450	3

Stat	Primary Soft Caps	Resistance/Defence Soft Caps
VIG	40, 60 for HP	40, 60 for Immunity 30, 40, 60 for Fire Defense
MIN	15, 35, 60 for FP	40, 60 for Focus
END	15, 30, 50 for Stamina 60 for Carry Capacity	30, 40, 60 for Robustness
STR	20, 55, 80 for AR	30, 40, 60 for Physical Defense
DEX	20, 55, 80 for AR 15, 30, 45 for Incantation Scaling	
INT	20, 50, 80 for AR 60, 80 for Sorcery Scaling	20, 35, 60 for Magic Defense
FTH	20, 50, 80 for AR 60, 80 for Incantation Scaling	
ARC	20, 50, 80 for AR 15, 30, 45 for Incantation/Sorcery Scaling 25, 45, 60 for melee status buildup 15, 30, 50 for projectile status e.g. pots 25, 45, 60 for Serpent Bow arrow status	15, 40, 60 for Vitality 20, 35, 60 for Holy Defense

Note: The scaling of AR on weapons or the sorcery/incantation scaling on staffs/seals depends on the weapon and its infusion, the above soft caps are approximations

Spacing, Spacing Weapon

Spacing is a form of positioning where the player positions themselves just barely outside of the range of an opponent's attack, so that they don't get hit but can punish their opponent for whiffing an attack.

Some weapons like paired straight swords are referred to as "spacing weapons", which means that you play them primarily by *spacing* and punishing your opponent for whiffing, or getting close to them and obtaining *priority*.

Spacing and *zoning* are both forms of space management, but spacing usually refers to management around individual attacks and *zoning* to the overall positioning while in neutral.

Split Damage vs. Pure Damage

A lot of weapons in Elden Ring, especially those infused with an affinity deal both physical and affinity damage (fire, magic, lightning, holy). This is called split damage. Weapons infused with Keen, Heavy, Standard, etc. will usually deal pure physical damage. Some weapons like the Coded Sword deal pure holy damage.

Generally speaking, pure damage is better than split damage, because pure damage only goes through one defence calculation. Players and enemies have defences (approximately 140), and the higher damage is in relation to that defence stat, the better.

The Sword of Night and Flame is a great example of a weapon that can achieve a very high attack rating, but deals little effective damage because its damage is split between magic, fire, and physical.

Stamina Damage [1.08]

When you hit a blocking opponent's shield, you deal a certain amount of stamina damage. This damage mostly depends on the attack and the weapon class, but there are small differences between weapons in the same class as well. The formula for melee stamina damage is approximately:

$$BaseStDmg \times UpgrMod \times \frac{StDmgMV}{100} \times (GF - \frac{GBoost \times AF}{100} \times GF) \times PvpMod$$

The formula for bullets is:

$$BulletStDmg \times (GF - \frac{GBoost \times AF}{100} \times GF) \times PvPMod$$

BaseStDmg*- A base stamina damage constant which depends on the weapon, usually between 20 and 100. Consider hammer talisman and other buffs to increase this value.*

BulletStDmg- *The stamina damage of a bullet, such as Thunderbolt or Kick. Kick does 999.*
GF- *A guard factor which depends on the buffs applied to the shield, or 1 if none apply. E.g. 0.5 when Barricade Shield is active, 0.8 for Greatshield Talisman. Buffs scale multiplicatively.*
GBoost - *A guard boost stat which depends on the shield, its infusion, and upgrade level. Increased by approximately 10 when two-handing the shield*
AF - *An attack factor which depends on the current attack, if any. 1 normally, 0.8 for torch poke, 0.75 for shield poke with small/medium shields, 0.7 for great shield poke.*
StDmgMV- *The stamina damage motion value of an attack. Usually 100 for a 1H R1.*
UpgrMod - *A constant which increases with upgrade levels of weapons. 1 for +0, 2 for +25.*
PvPMod - *A constant which increases stamina damage in PvP. 1.325 for melee attacks, 1.25 for ashes and spells.*

Weapon	**Move**	**Stamina Dmg MV / PvE Bullet Stamina Dmg**	**Max PvP Raw Stamina Dmg (Hammer Tali)**
Straight Sword *Best: Regalia (54 Base St. Dmg.)* *Best for Ashes: Broadsword (47 Base St. Dmg)*	2H R1	120	
	2H R2 100%	240	
	PS L1	180	
	PS JL1	220	
	Square Off R1 (Broadsword)	700	1151.5
	Square Off R2 (Broadsword)	240	
Katana *2nd Best: Nagakiba (45 Base St. Dmg.) (ignoring Meteoric)*	2H R1	120	
	2H R2 100%	250	
	PS JL1	250	
	Unsheathe R1	200	
	Unsheathe R2	300	
	Spinning Slash 1	150	
	Spinning Slash 2	85, 150	
Greatsword *Best: Iron Greatsword (70 Base St. Dmg)*	2H R1	120	
	2H R2	170	
	2H R2 100%	240	
	2H JR1	120	
	2H JR2	240	
Great Spear *Best: Serpent Hunter (73 Base St. Dmg.)*	2H R1	120	
	2H R2 100%	265	
	PS CL1	200	
	PS JL1	300	
Thrusting Sword Best: Cleanrot Knight (33 Base St. Dmg)	2H R1	200	
	2H R2 100%	300	
	2H JR2	350	
	PS JL1	310	

Heavy Thrusting Sword *Best: Cragblade (49 Base St. Dmg.)*	2H R1, JR1	200	
	2H R2	200	
	2H RR2	200	
	2H JR1	200	
	2H JR2	350	
Colossal Sword Best: Ruins (84 Base St. Dmg)	2H R1	120	
	2H R2	170	
	2H R2 100%	240	
	2H CR1	120	
	2H JR1	120	
	2H JR2	240	
Ashes of War	Flaming Strike Melee	200	
	Flaming Strike Bullet	100	
	Waves of Darkness Stab	100	
	Waves of Darkness Wave	70	
	Transient Moonlight Blade	100	
	Transient Moonlight Bullet	200	
	Shield Bash	500	
	Kick Bullet	999	1748.25
	Storm Stomp	100	
	Glintstone Pebble	150	
	Thunderbolt	40	
	Gravity Bolt	415	
	Bloodboon Ritual	80	
	Beast Roar	66	
Spells	Catch Flame	30	
	Bestial Sling	60	
	Bloodflame Talons	100	
	Carian Slicer	40	
	Carian Piercer	175 - 230	
	Giantsflame Take Thee	210 - 273	
	Placidusax's Ruin	400	
	Greyoll's Roar	220	
	Agheel's Flame	90	
	Wrath of Gold	240 - 290	

Note 1: Max Raw Stamina Dmg refers to the stamina damage dealt with the example weapon which is used as a representative for the weapon class, with Hammer Talisman equipped and the weapon fully upgraded.

Stance Cancelling aka. Ash of War Stagger Cancelling

The stance escape is a form of stagger cancelling which is limited to moves with damage level 3 and attack direction 0*. When hit in the back by such an attack, e.g. a UGS crouch poke, you can immediately use an ash of war instead of being staggered for long. A stance weapon art such as Unsheathe then lets you roll away much sooner, escaping the UGS vortex.

* Damage level is explained above, attack direction is a hidden attribute of attacks that indicates if they attack sideways or frontally. Attack direction 0 is a frontal attack, e.g. a thrusting move.

See also:

- New TECH! Escape ANY VORTEX! (YouTube)

Trade, Trading

When two players both hit each other at the same time, this is called a trade. There are different kinds of trades and different reasons why they occur.

Trade	Reason	Ways to Avoid
Perfect Trade	Players attack each other exactly at the same moment, i.e. their active attack frames connect with the enemy hurtbox at the same time.	Fundamentals, luck.
Poise Trade	One or both players would have been interrupted before landing an attack, but they poise the attack and land it anyways.	High poise damage weapons, e.g. UGS.
Hyperarmor Trade	Same principle as a Poise Trade, but caused by increased poise during HA.	Fast and high damage weapons, e.g. 2H Halberd.
Latency Trade	One or both players would have been interrupted before landing an attack, but because the hit takes too long to arrive on the opponent's screen (due to latency), they land it anyway.	Low recovery weapons, rolling away after each attack, e.g. PS straight swords.
Ranged Trade	Both players shoot projectiles at their opponent, and get hit while firing or during their recovery.	Don't fight ranged vs ranged.
Shield Poke Trade	One player attacks the other with a shield poke during their attack, possibly on reaction.	High range weapons, jump attacks.

Time to Kill (TTK)

The time to kill is a vague metric for how long it takes to kill other players in a game. Elden Ring at higher RL (rune level) is considered to have a low TTK. For example, many colossal swords can kill a player within seconds using 4 crouch pokes, and many ashes of war can deal well over 1000 damage, which should be roughly half a player's total HP.

True Combo

A true combo is a sequence of attacks which the opponent cannot escape (by rolling). Elden Ring has comparably few true combos, a lot of which may be unintentional.

Examples:

- 2H Heavy thrusting sword JR2 into R1
- 2H Heavy thrusting sword JR1 into R1
- 1H Guardian's Swordspear JR2 into R1
- Transient Moonlight R1 into R1, or into Carian Slicer
- 1H Colossal sword CR1 into offhand weapon
- Storm Stomp into numerous weapon attacks, most commonly R1

In Elden Ring, a combo is usually called "true" if it is not possible to roll out of it (disregarding poise). However, some of these combos can be escaped using Quickstep and other skills which enter i-frames immediately, because the hit-stun for some damage levels until L2 lasts shorter than the hit-stun until roll. Some of these combos are not true if the opponent poises a part of it. For example, an opponent with 91 poise can escape the heavy thrusting sword JR1 R1 true combo. Some true combos also require you to angle your weapon in a specific way, such as the Banished Knight's Greatsword JR1 R1 combo.

Unsheathe Vortex, Unsheathe Recovery Cancel, Moonveil Vortex, Moonveil Recovery Cancel

Unsheathe and Transient Moonlight (the Moonveil skill) usually end with a long recovery animation. This animation can be cancelled by rolling, jumping, crouching, or blocking, but the recovery into walking is very long.

You can use this to your advantage and immediately block or crouch after unsheathing, then hold L2 to sheathe again. This technique lets you unsheathe repeatedly at high speed. The cancel into crouch is the easiest to perform, since you just need to tap the crouch button and hold L2, whereas you need to be blocking for some time to cancel after Unsheathe.

This also results in a *vortex*, because Unsheathe into Unsheathe is a roll-catching combo, and since Unsheathe is quite difficult to reaction-roll at point blank.

Vigor Check

A vigor check happens when a player's HP bar is emptied in a single hit or a single attack, revealing exactly how much health they had, and thus how much vigor they have. It is a humorous term, used especially when encountering players with low vigor who get killed quickly by attacks that wouldn't have killed a player with a better build.

For reference, at RL (rune level) 125, a player should typically have 60 vigor, or very close to that.

Vortex

A vortex is a situation where a player is at a disadvantage and can't easily reset to neutral because taking the wrong action (e.g. panic rolling) keeps them in the same disadvantaged state.

For example, after you have been hit by a Great Spear crouch poke, you are staggered for a large amount of time. You are then at a disadvantage, because you can be hit by a follow-up poke before performing any attack yourself. A follow-up poke can be very difficult to react to, so you are somewhat forced to panic roll. However, a panic roll is also not a good option, because Great Spear is an excellent weapon for roll-catching.

The Great Spear vortex is the most extreme example of a vortex in Elden Ring, but some other examples are:

- Halberd+Offstoc vortex
- Unsheathe/Moonveil vortex
- PS Great Hammers/Greataxes vortex

Wavedashing aka. Goblin Step

Wavedashing is a technique which is used to perform crouch attacks while running. It works by repeatedly crouching and un-crouching while running. For a few steps after un-crouching, it is possible to perform a crouch attack, even though the player is running.

See also:

- Elden Ring - WAVEDASH Guide (YouTube)

Weapon Art

This is the Dark Souls 3 term for weapon skills. In Elden Ring, they are referred to as skills when used, and ashes of war when talking about adding a skill to a weapon.

Whiff

A player whiffs, i.e. their attack is whiffed if they fail to hit their opponent due to improper spacing. This can either happen because they didn't close enough distance before attacking, or they didn't wait for their opponent to close distance.

Whiff-Punish

A whiff typically puts the opponent at an advantage, allowing them to attack and hit the whiffing player, which is called a whiff-punish.

Zoning

Zoning is whatever series of tactics a player uses to keep their opponent at a specific distance. The goal is to use projectiles, long-ranged attacks, fast and safe moves, to apply pressure, and to force your opponent into a disadvantage.

Sorcery and Light Bow are examples of playstyles/weapons which rely heavily on zoning, always attempting to keep their opponent within range of their projectiles, but also attempting to stay away from their melee attacks, assuming they are being chased after.

Spacing and *zoning* are both forms of space management, but spacing usually refers to management around individual attacks and zoning to the overall positioning while in neutral.